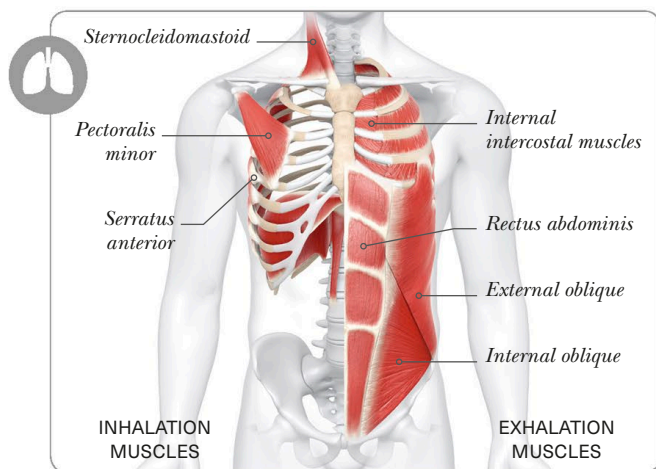


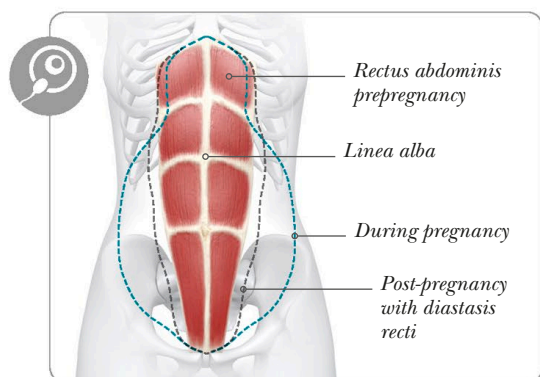
» CLOSER LOOK

Side Plank involves deep breaths, recruiting more respiratory muscles than usual. There is also significant core muscle engagement, which is good for scoliosis, but poses risks for pregnancy.



Respiratory muscles

In a natural breath, your diaphragm is the main player. When you breathe deeply, as in this pose, other accessory respiratory muscles can be recruited. The inhale involves the muscles above left, along with small muscles along your neck called the scalenes. The exhale also involves deep muscles along your ribs called transversus thoracis.



Pregnancy caution

The linea alba is the connective tissue joining the sections of the rectus abdominis. During pregnancy, pressure can separate this tissue, causing a condition called diastasis recti or abdominal separation. For this reason, be cautious of poses that involve abdominal engagement and pressure while pregnant, particularly later in pregnancy.

